

So4 Case 1: FeedBurner — Exercise Solutions

Posted after class

Wed Sep 16, 2026 · Yale SOM · Prof. John M. Barrios

Exercise: score the FeedBurner Four

Pairs — 3 minutes. Using the factor weights below, compute the Demmler share for YOUR assigned founder (assigned by seating row). Weighted score = $\Sigma(\text{weight} \times \text{score})$; share = your founder's weighted score $\div$ team total. One percentage per pair.

Factor	Costolo	Olechowski	Lunt	Shobe
Idea	8	6	7	4
Domain expertise	7	7	9	6
Commitment & risk	8	8	8	7
Role going forward	9	7	8	5

These are my scores — disagree with them if the facts support it.

Factor weights (Idea / Expertise / Commitment / Role): 5 / 7 / 9 / 6

Answer: the Demmler split

Founder	Weighted score	Share
Costolo	215	27.5%
Olechowski	193	24.7%
Lunt	218	27.9%
Shobe	155	19.8%
Team total	781	100%

Costolo = $5 \times 8 + 7 \times 7 + 9 \times 8 + 6 \times 9 = 40 + 49 + 72 + 54 = 215$; $215 \div 781 = 27.5\%$.

Every weighting says $\approx 28 / 25 / 28 / 19$ — never $25 / 25 / 25 / 25$. FeedBurner chose equal anyway. What does equal buy?